

In פרשת נשא, we read the most wonderful ברכות that we have in all of the תורה. ברכת כהנים gave this special ברכה in the המקדש, and for all generations we have the same ברכה. רש"י explains that יברכך ה' means Hashem will give us money and guard us from danger. The דברי יחזקאל asks, it would seem that we need the opposite order, we should be guarded from danger and only after receive money. Why does רש"י present it in this order, with money first and only afterward protection?

The Sfas Emes brings a pasuk in (ק"ה:ל"ז) הַשֵּׁשׁ הָיָה בְּכֶסֶף וְזָהָב וְאֵין בְּשִׁבְכָתָיו כּוֹשֵׁל: מהילדים. What does that mean? Hashem took בני ישראל out of מצרים with silver and gold, and there was nobody who was poor amongst the שבטים. What does it mean that no one was “poor”? It means that no one failed in their נסיונות with their יצר הרע. The Sfas Emes is telling us that דוד המלך wants to teach us that בני ישראל took הקב"ה out of מצרים with all of this wealth, it was not their downfall. As we know, money can be someone’s great downfall, but in this case, money did not spoil them.

I saw a fascinating דבר תורה in the name of R' Mendel of Riminov. He asks: who are the כהנים talking to when they recite ברכת כהנים? The כהנים are speaking to כלל ישראל, the ציבור standing listening to the duchaning. And yet, every single word in the duchaning is in לשון יחיד, it says יברכך, not יברככם, and וישמרך, not וישמרכם. Why is that?

R' Mendel answers that a ברכה for one person may not be a ברכה for another person. You can't make a general כלל, giving a single ברכה for everyone and expect it to be "one size fits all." Each and every individual needs to receive the ברכה that is appropriate for him, for what he needs, for what his desires are, and הקב"ה should fulfill them לטובה.

R' Mendel said that he once had a dream in which he went up to שמים and he heard a מלאך daven to Hashem to give all of the Yidden tremendous wealth. "Look Hashem, all the Yidden are so frum, they're so careful with mitzvos, and they're living under such difficult circumstances. Give each of them money and they'll be even better, they'll do more mitzvos." The Rebbe asked in his dream, "What's the name of this מלאך who's asking this request?" And he was told this מלאך's name is the שטן. The Rebbe cried out, "גאט זאל אפהיטן from the טובות of the שטן."

May we all get wonderful and appropriate ברכות that Hashem wishes to shower upon us לטובה and not just סתם, given indiscriminately to everyone. Each and every Yid should get what's appropriate for him and in that זכות, we should be able to fulfill all the מצוות to the best of our ability, and even greater.

